VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN)

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY → THREE CONTESTED ZONES → FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER → VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE → WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN → AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY

DECCAN POLITICAL CHRONOLOGY · c. 1336 · CONVENTIONAL VIJAYANAGARA FOUNDATION ANCHOR · BAHMANI KINGDOM ESTABLISHED UNDER ALAUDDIN HASAN BAHMAN SHAH; · DEVA RAYA II STRENGTHENS VIJAYANAGARA MILITARY ADAPTATION · BAHMANI CAPITAL SHIFTS FROM GULBARGA TO BIDAR · KRISHNADEVA RAYA AND TULUVA APOGEE · TALIKOTA DESTROYS THE CAPITAL FABRIC; ARAVIDU POWER CONTINUES.

c. 1336 — conventional Vijayanagara foundation anchor → 1347 — Bahmani kingdom established under Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah → 1420s-40s — Deva Raya II strengthens Vijayanagara military adaptation → 1425 — Bahmani capital shifts from Gulbarga to Bidar → 1509-29 — Krishnadeva Raya and Tuluva apogee

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- c. 1336 — conventional Vijayanagara foundation anchor
- 1347 — Bahmani kingdom established under Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah
- 1420s-40s — Deva Raya II strengthens Vijayanagara military adaptation

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1425 — Bahmani capital shifts from Gulbarga to Bidar
- 1509-29 — Krishnadeva Raya and Tuluva apogee
- 1565 — Talikota destroys the capital fabric; Aravidu power continues.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Vijayanagara-Bahmani rivalry joined doab, basin, coast, ports and horse supply
- it was not a communal binary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Vijayanagara-Bahmani rivalry joined doab, basin, coast, ports and horse supply;.

01

STAGE 01 THREE CONTESTED ZONES

THREE CONTESTED ZONES · TUNGABHADRA DOAB · FERTILE FRONTIER, FORTS AND RECURRING CAMPAIGNS · AGRARIAN BASIN, ROUTES AND EASTERN-COAST CONNECTIONS · PORTS, CUSTOMS, HORSE IMPORTS AND WESTERN MARITIME ACCESS · REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS = PRESTIGE · POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY EXPLAINS MORE THAN A HINDU-MUSLIM BINARY.

TUNGABHADRA DOAB — fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns

KRISHNA-GODAVARI — agrarian basin, routes and eastern-coast connections → KONKAN-GOA — ports, customs, horse imports and western maritime access → REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS = PRESTIGE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns
- KRISHNA-GODAVARI → agrarian basin, routes and eastern-coast connections

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- KONKAN-GOA — ports, customs, horse imports and western maritime access
- REVENUE + CAVALRY + LOGISTICS = PRESTIGE

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.
- TUNGABHADRA DOAB → fertile frontier, forts and recurring campaigns

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: political geography explains more than a Hindu-Muslim binary.

02

STAGE 02 FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER

FOUNDATION AND EVIDENCE LADDER · CONVENTIONAL VIJAYANAGARA ANCHOR; HARIHARA/BUKKA BIOGRAPHIES DEBATED · VIDYARANYA STORY · LATER FOUNDATION MEMORY, NOT A SETTLED EVENT TRANSCRIPT · ALAUDDIN HASAN BAHMAN SHAH; HASAN GANGU/DESCENT TRADITIONS CAUTIONED · INSCRIPTIONS + COINS + HAMPI/GULBARGA/BIDAR ARCHAEOLOGY · PERSIAN CHRONICLES + SANSKRIT/TELUGU/KANNADA/TAMIL EVIDENCE · CONTI/RAZZAQ/PAES/NUNIZ WITH DATE, AUDIENCE AND NUMBER LIMITS

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
1336 — conventional Vijayanagara anchor; Harihara/Bukka biographies debated	EVIDENCE — inscriptions + coins + Hampi/Gulbarga/Bidar archaeology	RULE: chronology may be secure while origin narratives remain contested.
VIDYARANYA STORY — later foundation memory, not a settled event transcript	TEXTS — Persian chronicles + Sanskrit/Telugu/Kannada/Tamil evidence	
1347 — Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah; Hasan Gangu/descent traditions cautioned	TRAVELLERS — Conti/Razzaq/Paes/Nuniz with date, audience and number limits	

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- 1336 — conventional Vijayanagara anchor; Harihara/Bukka biographies debated
- VIDYARANYA STORY — later foundation memory, not a settled event transcript
- 1347 — Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah; Hasan Gangu/descent traditions cautioned

METHOD / DEBATE

- EVIDENCE — inscriptions + coins + Hampi/Gulbarga/Bidar archaeology
- TEXTS — Persian chronicles + Sanskrit/Telugu/Kannada/Tamil evidence
- TRAVELLERS — Conti/Razzaq/Paes/Nuniz with date, audience and number limits

HISTORICAL RESULT

- RULE: chronology may be secure while origin narratives remain contested.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: chronology may be secure while origin narratives remain contested.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: chronology may be secure while origin narratives remain contested.

03

STAGE 03 VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE

VIJAYANAGARA DYNASTIC SEQUENCE · DEVA RAYA I · DEVA RAYA II · LATE SANGAMA CRISIS · PROVINCIAL AND SUCCESSION PRESSURES · NARASIMHA RESTORES ORDER THROUGH DYNASTIC SEIZURE · VIRA NARASIMHA · ALIYA RAMA RAYA

SANGAMA — Harihara/Bukka — Deva Raya I — Deva Raya II → LATE SANGAMA CRISIS — provincial and succession pressures → SALUVA — Narasimha restores order through dynastic seizure → TULUVA — Vira Narasimha — Krishnadevaraya — Achyuta — Sadashiva → ALIYA RAMA RAYA — effective power and shifting Deccan alliances

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- SANGAMA → Harihara/Bukka → Deva Raya I → Deva Raya II
- LATE SANGAMA CRISIS — provincial and succession pressures
- SALUVA → Narasimha restores order through dynastic seizure

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- TULUVA → Vira Narasimha → Krishnadevaraya → Achyuta → Sadashiva
- ALIYA RAMA RAYA → effective power and shifting Deccan alliances
- 1565 → capital/great power rupture; ARAVIDU → Tirumala and continuities

IMPACT / LIMIT

- RULE: dynasty changes altered capacity without creating four unrelated states.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: dynasty changes altered capacity without creating four unrelated states.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: dynasty changes altered capacity without creating four unrelated states.

04

STAGE 04 WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN CAPACITY

WATER, CAPITAL AND AGRARIAN CAPACITY · TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS CULTIVATION + URBAN · STATE CAPACITY, BUT BENEFITS AND CONTROL REMAINED SOCIALLY UNEQUAL · UNESCO BRIDGE · HYDRAULIC REMAINS SUPPORT INTEGRATION, NOT A WELFARE CENSUS.

TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual → water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience → STATE CAPACITY, but benefits and control remained socially unequal → UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual
- water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- STATE CAPACITY, but benefits and control remained socially unequal
- UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- TUNGABHADRA LANDSCAPE + TANKS + CANALS cultivation + urban supply + ritual
- water + military provisioning taxable surplus + metropolitan density + resilience

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNESCO bridge: hydraulic remains support integration, not a welfare census.

05

STAGE 05 AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN

AMARAM AND NAYAKA BARGAIN · RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM · TERRITORIAL COMMAND · NAYAKA MAINTAINS TROOPS, REMITS OBLIGATIONS AND GOVERNS LOCALLY SERVICE · HEREDITARY DRIFT, BARGAINING AND LATER NAYAKA POLITIES · COMPARISON WITH IQTA IS FUNCTIONAL, NOT AN EQUATION.

RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND → NAYAKA maintain troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also → entrenches regional power weak centre → hereditary drift, bargaining and later nayaka polities → CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND
- NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- entrenches regional power weak centre → hereditary drift, bargaining and later nayaka polities
- CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULER ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM / TERRITORIAL COMMAND
- NAYAKA maintains troops, remits obligations and governs locally service produces military reach but also

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: comparison with iqta is functional, not an equation.

06

STAGE 06 HORSE-PORT-MILITARY CHAIN

HORSE-PORT-MILITARY CHAIN · WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY · KONKAN ROUTES · INLAND MOVEMENT AND PAYMENT CAVALRY RECRUITMENT + ARCHERY + · IMPORTED HORSES MATTERED, BUT DID NOT ALONE DECIDE WARS.

WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY — PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS

GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES — inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment + → archery + commanders + fodder and remounts competitive adaptation by Vijayanagara and Deccan states → RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY — PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
- GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES — inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- archery + commanders + fodder and remounts competitive adaptation by Vijayanagara and Deccan states
- RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- WEST ASIAN HORSE SUPPLY — PORTS / MERCHANTS / CUSTOMS
- GOA / BHATKAL / KONKAN ROUTES — inland movement and payment cavalry recruitment +

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: imported horses mattered, but did not alone decide wars.

07

STAGE 07 HAMPI URBAN SYSTEM

HAMPI URBAN SYSTEM · FORTS/ENCLOSURES + ROYAL CENTRE + SACRED CENTRE + SETTLEMENTS · TANKS/CANALS/AQUEDUCTS LINK CULTIVATION, MARKETS AND PROVISIONING · OLDER VIRUPAKSHA + PHASE-BUILT VITTHALA + HAZARA RAMA · TEMPLES + FESTIVALS + CRAFTS + MERCHANTS + LONG-DISTANCE · LOTUS MAHAL · ELEPHANT STABLES · CONVENTIONAL LABELS; FUNCTIONS CAUTIONED

LANDSCAPE — forts/enclosures + royal centre + sacred centre + settlements → WATER — tanks/canals/aqueducts link cultivation, markets and provisioning → SITES — older Virupaksha + phase-built Vitthala + Hazara Rama → MARKETS — temples + festivals + crafts + merchants + long-distance routes → LOTUS MAHAL / ELEPHANT STABLES — conventional labels; functions cautioned

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LANDSCAPE — forts/enclosures + royal centre + sacred centre + settlements
- WATER — tanks/canals/aqueducts link cultivation, markets and provisioning
- SITES — older Virupaksha + phase-built Vitthala + Hazara Rama

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MARKETS — temples + festivals + crafts + merchants + long-distance routes
- LOTUS MAHAL / ELEPHANT STABLES — conventional labels; functions cautioned
- SOURCE RULE — building proves patronage/material form, not a social census

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Hampi was an urban region, not only a palace or temple complex.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Hampi was an urban region, not only a palace or temple complex.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hampi was an urban region, not only a palace or temple complex.

08

STAGE 08 BAHMANI STATE AND CAPITAL SHIFT

BAHMANI STATE AND CAPITAL SHIFT · 1347 GULBARGA · FOUNDATION, FRONTIER COMMAND AND EARLY CONSOLIDATION · 1425 BIDAR · REVISED STRATEGIC CENTRE AND COURTLY-CULTURAL INVESTMENT · PROVINCIAL COMMAND, REVENUE AND MILITARY RESOURCES LATE 15TH C. · STRONGER FACTIONS AND SUCCESSOR-STATE FORMATION · CAPITAL SHIFT IS NOT THE SAME EVENT AS DYNASTIC

1347 GULBARGA — foundation, frontier command and early consolidation → 1425 BIDAR — revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment → TARAFS — provincial command, revenue and military resources late 15th c. — stronger factions and → TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1347 GULBARGA — foundation, frontier command and early consolidation
- 1425 BIDAR — revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- TARAFS — provincial command, revenue and military resources late 15th c. — stronger factions and successor-state formation
- TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1347 GULBARGA — foundation, frontier command and early consolidation
- 1425 BIDAR — revised strategic centre and courtly-cultural investment

MECHANISM / VERDICT — TRAP: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: capital shift is not the same event as dynastic foundation.

09

STAGE 09 MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC

MAHMUD GAWAN REFORM LOGIC · LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY MORE · FACTIONAL RESISTANCE · GAWAN'S EXECUTION · SOUND DESIGN CAN FAIL WITHOUT A DURABLE GOVERNING COALITION. · CLOSE DISTINCTION · VIJAYANAGARA AMARAM/NAYAKA SERVICE AND BAHMANI TARAF ADMINISTRATION ARE COMPARABLE

LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control → enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control — factional resistance — Gawan's → LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition. → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Vijayanagara amaram/nayaka service and Bahmani taraf administration are comparable but not identical institutions.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa
- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's execution

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LESSON: sound design can fail without a durable governing coalition.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Vijayanagara amaram/nayaka service and Bahmani taraf administration are comparable but not identical institutions.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LARGE TARAFLANDS + POWERFUL GOVERNORS + ELITE RIVALRY more provinces + forts under tighter control + khalisa
- enlargement measurement, cash expectations and central checks greater intended control → factional resistance → Gawan's execution

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Vijayanagara amaram/nayaka service and Bahmani taraf administration are comparable but not identical institutions.

10

STAGE 10 DECCANI-AFAQI COALITION PROBLEM

DECCANI-AFAQI COALITION PROBLEM · LONGER-SETTLED REGIONAL MUSLIM ELITES AND ALLIES · NEWER WESTERN AND CENTRAL ASIAN MIGRANTS AND NETWORKS · OFFICE, PATRONAGE, MILITARY COMMAND AND COURT ACCESS · CROSS-CUTTING TIES · MARRIAGE, LANGUAGE, SERVICE AND LOCAL ALLIANCE · FACTIONAL LABELS STRUCTURE POLITICS BUT ARE NOT RACIAL ABSOLUTES · DO NOT TURN ELITE RIVALRY INTO A TIMELESS COMMUNAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
DECCANIS — longer-settled regional Muslim elites and allies	CROSS-CUTTING TIES — marriage, language, service and local alliance	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Talikota (1565) was a destructive turning point, not the instantaneous extinction of all Vijayanagara authority.
AFAQIS — newer western and Central Asian migrants and networks	OUTCOME — factional labels structure politics but are not racial absolutes	
COMPETITION — office, patronage, military command and court access	TRAP: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DECCANIS — longer-settled regional Muslim elites and allies
- AFAQIS — newer western and Central Asian migrants and networks
- COMPETITION — office, patronage, military command and court access

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CROSS-CUTTING TIES — marriage, language, service and local alliance
- OUTCOME — factional labels structure politics but are not racial absolutes
- TRAP: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Talikota (1565) was a destructive turning point, not the instantaneous extinction of all Vijayanagara authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: do not turn elite rivalry into a timeless communal conflict.

11

STAGE 11 TOPIC 09 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 09 ANSWER SPINE · DATE + GENRE + BIAS + CORROBORATION · RAICHUR/DOAB + KRISHNA-GODAVARI + KONKAN/PORTS/HORSES · AMARAM/NAYAKA/AYAGAR VERSUS TARAF/KHALISA/GAWAN REFORMS · SEGMENTARY + CENTRALIZED + MILITARY-FISCAL + INTEGRATIVE READINGS · AGRARIAN/URBAN GROUPS + TEMPLES/MOSQUES/DARGAHS + MULTILINGUAL COURTS · COALITION + RAMA RAYA + SACK, THEN ARAVIDU/NAYAKA PERSISTENCE · CHANGING DECCAN STATES, NOT A FEUDAL OR COMMUNAL BINARY.

SOURCE — date + genre + bias + corroboration → SPACE — Raichur/doab + Krishna-Godavari + Konkan/ports/horses → STATE — amaram/nayaka/ayagar versus taraf/khalisa/Gawan reforms → DEBATE — segmentary + centralized + military-fiscal + integrative readings → SOCIETY — agrarian/urban groups + temples/mosques/dargahs + multilingual courts

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SOURCE — date + genre + bias + corroboration
- SPACE — Raichur/doab + Krishna-Godavari + Konkan/ports/horses
- STATE — amaram/nayaka/ayagar versus taraf/khalisa/Gawan reforms

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DEBATE — segmentary + centralized + military-fiscal + integrative readings
- SOCIETY — agrarian/urban groups + temples/mosques/dargahs + multilingual courts
- 1565 — coalition + Rama Raya + sack, then Aravidu/nayaka persistence

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: changing Deccan states, not a feudal or communal binary.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: changing Deccan states, not a feudal or communal binary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: changing Deccan states, not a feudal or communal binary.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · VIJAYANAGARA & THE BAHMANI KINGDOM (DECCAN) — ADVANCED · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS · 6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Vijayanagara & the Bahmani Kingdom (Deccan) — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept: Horses and state power
- Deva Raya II's army reform was a response to Bahmani superiority in horses and mounted archers.
- The 1367 conflict is important not merely for violence but for the treaty

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels